The Arrow Under the Bridge

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 2

Nib turned the channel diagram until its prettiest tree matched a nearby trunk. The bridge in the drawing then pointed in an impossible direction. Lark set the page against the real fixed bridge instead. Inlet, gate, alternate route, and outlet could now keep the same relationship on paper and ground.

“The arrow is wandering,” Nib complained mildly. “Our page is turning,” Lark observed gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **note**

“A diagram's arrows tell us relationships and direction,” Lark explained clearly. “Read in-let and out-let as joined familiar parts. We'll orient the page to the fixed bridge before following an arrow, then check that its endpoint matches the place we reach.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inlet, outlet, chart. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read inlet and outlet on the chart,” Lark invited gently. “Which arrow gives the first upstream inspection?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The inlet is at the top. The outlet is at the end.**

“Which label belongs at the end in this little diagram description?” Lark asked gently. “Use the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib walked along the dry route beside the inlet arrow. Lark checked its endpoint against the real access place. They reached the intended inspection point without entering the water or turning a control. A keeper's crowded page waited in the notebook pocket, describing what had last been noticed here.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write inlet beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the oriented chart. The bridge stayed the fixed reference. Now the crew had to find the useful water observations among the keeper page's many other details.